



Perfection is achieved not when
there is nothing left to add, but
when there is nothing left to
take away —

Antoine de Saint-Exupery

Style Guide

Guidelines for technical documentation

This page is intentionally left blank.

Table of Contents

1. About	1
2. Style	3
2.1. Element names	3
2.2. Voice	3
2.3. Numbers	3
2.4. Conciseness	4
2.5. Capitalization	4
2.6. Acronyms	4
2.7. Procedures and lists	4
2.8. Wording/Grammar	5
2.9. Warnings, Cautions, and Notes	5
3. Illustrations	7
3.1. Format	7
3.2. Callouts	8
3.3. Callout boxes	9
4. Tooling	15
4.1. Paligo	15
4.2. Rules for locations	15
4.3. Rules for Media file names	15
5. Interaction Terms	17
6. Document Structure	19
6.1. Overall Structure of Chapters	19
6.2. Other Patterns	20
7. Indexing	21
8. Terms	23

This page is intentionally left blank.

1. About

This style guide is a general guideline for SurePoint's visual and written communication. It outlines the standards for tone and imagery to ensure consistency across documents. Following these guidelines allows every team member to create content that aligns with other SurePoint content. Note that this is a **guide**, not a set of absolute rules. If the specifications in the guide don't fit your particular use, you may deviate. It is more important to get the point across clearly than to be perfectly consistent.

This page is intentionally left blank.

2. Style

These are general rules for SurePoint's technical documentation.

2.1. Element names

- Always refer to elements by their UI label when available.
- If no UI label exists, refer to the element by its function and where possible use a screenshot and callout to indicate its location to readers.
- When a screen has no visible title, refer to it by its primary function.
- Use exact capitalization only for visible buttons, tabs, fields, and icons.

2.2. Voice

Use active voice with imperatives, not passive voice:

- "Place the flowmeter on the bracket."

not:

- "The flowmeter should be placed on the bracket."

Avoid overly friendly or imprecise language:

- "Clean Sentinel flowmeter tubes every 100 hours."

not:

- "It is good to occasionally clean the Sentinel flowmeter tubes"

Use present tense whenever possible.

Avoid the use of "You" in favor of imperatives with understood you:

- "Observe system operation to determine flow."

not:

- "You should see flow through the system."

2.3. Numbers

- Spell out whole numbers one through nine.

- Use numerals for 10 and above.
- Always use numerals for interface elements, measurements, units, and percentages.
- When a sentence contains quantities both below and above 10, use numerals for all quantities to maintain consistency.

2.4. Conciseness

- Express one idea per sentence whenever possible.
- Fewer words are better.
- Use the shortest wording that accurately communicates the information. Remove anything that does not help the reader complete a task, understand a concept, or make a decision.
- Avoid redundant phrases such as "in order to," "at this time," and "due to the fact that."

2.5. Capitalization

- Use exact capitalization for all interface elements, even when the capitalization differs from these guidelines.
- Use Title Case for headings.
- Always use official capitalization for product names.

2.6. Acronyms

- Spell out acronyms on first use.
- Do not assume users know the expansion of an acronym.

2.7. Procedures and lists

- Use bullets for non-sequential information and numbered lists for procedures.
- Place ordered list steps in the order they are performed.
- When the procedure has a result, tell the reader what it is.
- Use a period at the end of each list item.
- Constrain each list item to only one primary action.
- Use imperative verbs to start procedure steps: Select, Enter, Verify, Connect, Route, Install, Mount, Open, Return.

Make lists and procedures grammatically parallel whenever practical:

- 1) Select start. 2) Observe condition. 3) Adjust setting.

not:

- 1) Select start. 2) Condition observation. 3) Adjusting setting.

2.8. Wording/Grammar

Avoid slash constructions: "testing or calibrating" over "testing/calibrating"

Avoid "below" when possible, because of pagination issues. Use "...the following illustration..."

2.9. Warnings, Cautions, and Notes

Use admonitions to draw attention to safety information, equipment risks, requirements, or supplemental information.

- **Danger:** Indicates a hazardous situation that will result in death or serious injury if not avoided.
- **Warning:** Indicates a hazardous situation that could result in injury if not avoided.
- **Caution:** Indicates a situation that could result in equipment damage, data loss, or reduced system performance if not avoided.
- **Notice:** Indicates important information about operation, procedures, or requirements that is not related to personal safety.
- **Important:** Highlights information that is critical to successful task completion or proper system operation.
- **Note:** Supplemental information, clarification, or context.
- **Tip:** Provides a recommendation, shortcut, or best practice that may improve efficiency or ease of use.

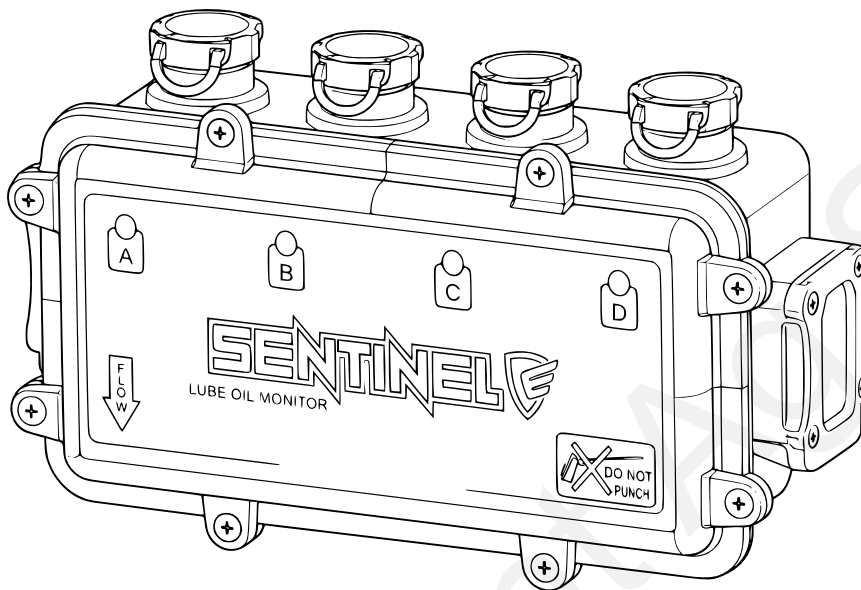
This page is intentionally left blank.

3. Illustrations

3.1. Format

Prefer SVG line drawings for illustrations whenever possible (Illustrator files are less suitable for HTML and vector files are infinitely zoomable)

Use this:



Not this:



Note: Work with engineering to export images in this format (specifically harness diagrams)

Illustration styles

Prefer line drawings at $\frac{3}{4}$ view for hardware

Show an establishing illustration first (when needed) then detail views

3.2. Callouts

Switch to leader lines and round boxes

Colors TBD based on new UI colors

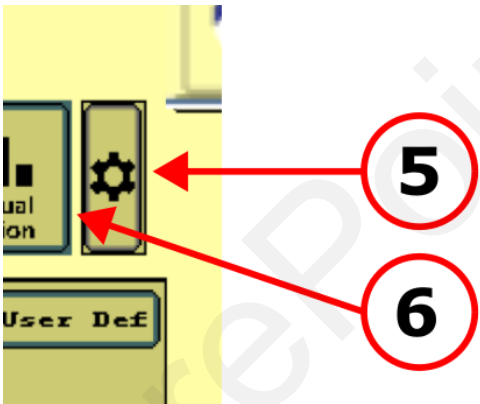
.5mm thickness with classic/triangle arrowhead

Use a straight leader line, parallel to page top/bottom when possible

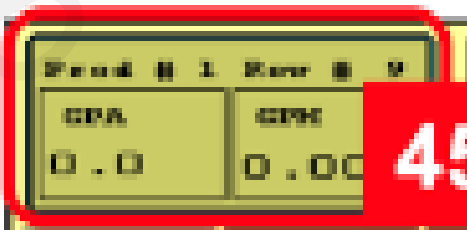
Leader lines should not intersect

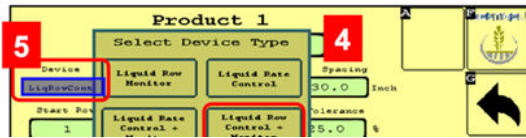
Draw lines so no relevant UI elements are obscured

This:



Not these:





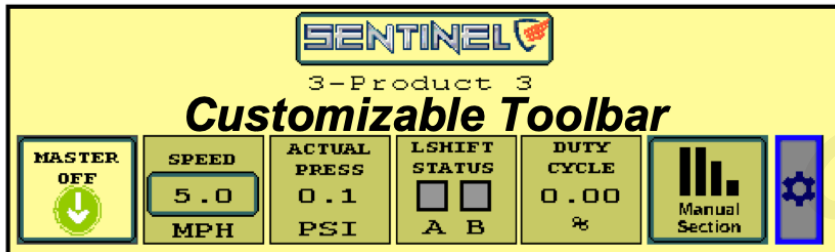
4.) Enter a name for the Product.

5.) Press the box under "Device".

Note the callout number (45) partially obscuring the UI element in the first example, and the popup dialog and callout number (4) completely obscuring the Name field in the second.

Do not add text directly to screenshots:

Returning to the Main Screen without loss



Note the "Customizable Toolbar" text above. There is no indication that this is not part of the actual UI.

3.3. Callout boxes

- .5mm thickness
- Minimum 5mm padding
- Round corners
- No callout boxes inside callout boxes

- Cleanly capture complete, individual elements only
- This:



- Not this



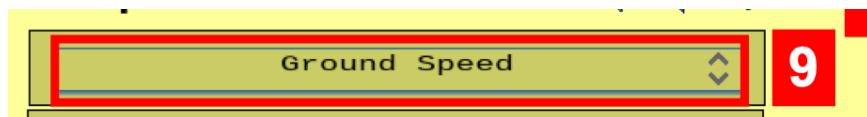
- Ensure relevant UI elements are not obscured

The (4) callout above covers the **Name** field.

- Place elements completely within box borders
- This



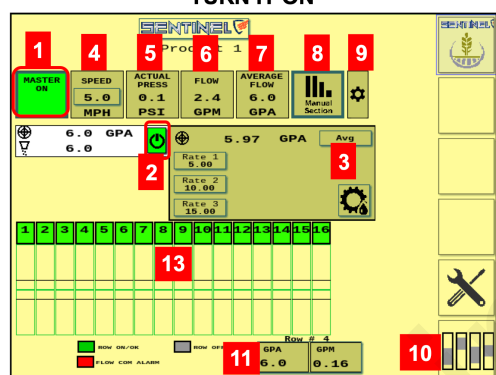
- Not this



Screen captures/UI - UI on left and procedure/element labels on the right of the page

This:

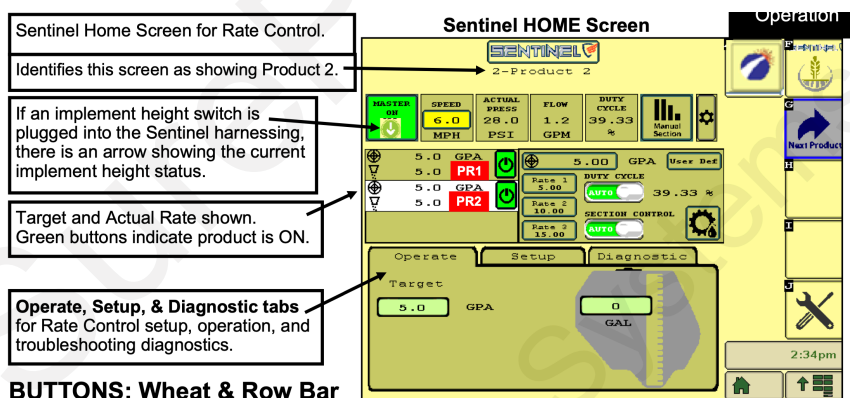
Operating Sentinel Row Monitoring TURN IT ON



For Sentinel Row Monitoring to work,

- (1) MASTER ON button must be green, and (2) the Product ON/OFF button must be green.
- (3) For Row Monitoring, Rate Mode is normally AVG.
- (4) Sentinel will not operate until a SPEED is registered. Enter simulated speed here.
- (5) The system pressure will not read here unless Sentinel is controlling LiquiShift, but will be shown on the Rate Controller screen.
- (6) Set up Total Flow / Min for this reading measured by the Sentinel flowmeter modules.
- (7) Set up Avg Flow / Area for this reading measured by the Sentinel flowmeter modules.
- (8) Manual Sections doesn't do anything for Row Monitoring. It works with Rate Control.
- (9) Press this button to select which icons show up on this row of buttons. (see #14 below)

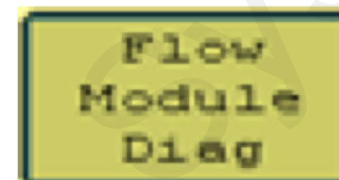
Not this:



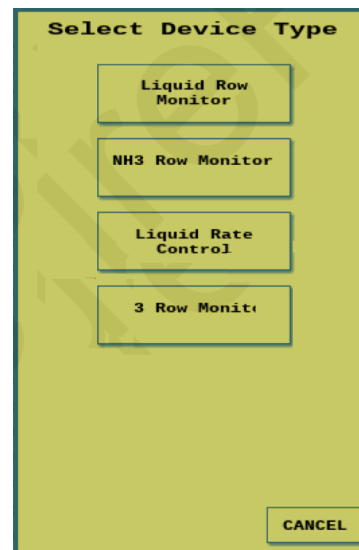
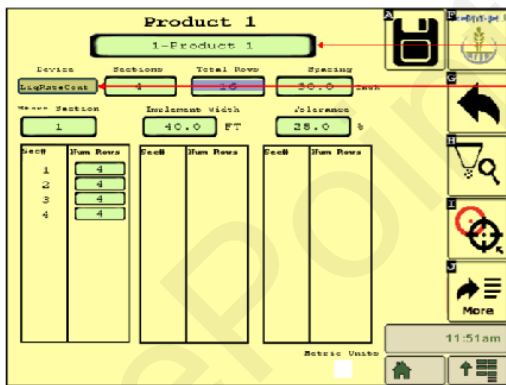
- Adjust / Replace button text on overly pixelated / blurred UI elements
- These



- Not these



- Do not use overlapping images
- These



- Over this

Product 1

Select Device Type

Device: **LiqRateCont** (5)

Start Sect1: 1

Spacing: 30.0 Inch (4)

Tolerance: 25.0 %

Num Rows:

Sec#

1	
2	
3	
4	
5	
6	
7	
8	
9	
10	
11	
12	

Liquid Row Monitor

NH3 Row Monitor

Liquid Rate Control

Liquid Rate Control + Monitor (6)

CANCEL

Reset Total

Metric Units ☐

More

This page is intentionally left blank.

4. Tooling

This section provides information about Paligo and our document structure.

4.1. Paligo

Paligo's editing tools are fairly self-explanatory. If you have a problem with validation:

- Copy the XML to Copilot and ask for validation, or
- Ask for assistance.

If you can't get Paligo's editor to perform a particular function (if it complains about validation or you get the "Cannot insert text here" error) move the cursor between elements and attempt to insert a paragraph. If that still doesn't work, you can view the XML source and make edits there.

4.2. Rules for locations

Place:

- Topic source files in the 01-Topics folder.
- Document files in the 02-Documents folder.
- Images in the Media folder.

Sub folders are provided in each of those by category and specific product.

Within the Media folder for the product, place images in buttons/ screenshots/ illustrations/ or other/ as appropriate.

4.3. Rules for Media file names

Use human-readable file names to make media easier to find and identify:

- sentinel_ss_row_monitoring.png

not:

- rm_ss_12345.png

Use the format <product>_<image type>_<name>_<partnumber>

This allows a writer to easily locate and identify images. Even if an image is in the incorrect folder, it will still be identifiable by its name.

**IMPORTANT**

DO NOT upload images with default names like image.png or 1.ai.

Type	Abbreviation
Screenshot	ss
sentinel_ss_row_monitoring.png	
Button	btn
sentinel_btn_catch_test.png	
Illustration/drawing	ill
sentinel_ill_row_mon_plumbing.svg	

5. Interaction Terms

Use **select** for buttons, checkboxes, and other touch elements.

- **Select Enable LiquiShift** to enable LiquiShift on the system.
- **Select START** to start applying product.

Use **enter** for text fields.

- **Enter** a **Max RPM** for your pump.
- **Enter** a product name.

For on/off toggles, use **select to toggle between**.

- **Select Section** to toggle between **AUTO** and **MAN**.

For screen names, use **Title Case** and <guilabel> with **screen** in lower case.

- The **Hardware** screen opens.

For button names, prefer:

- The actual UI label if it exists.
- A functional/purpose name using **Title Case**.

Prefer	Over
Select	Tap
Open	Launch
Connect	Plug
Install	Mount
Configure	Set up
Update	Upgrade
Verify	Check

Set up / setup

- Use **set up** as a verb. Use **setup** as a noun or adjective.
- Set up Sentinel or Review the setup screens

CAN bus

- **CAN** is the acronym, **bus** a noun.
- Avoid **CAN BUS** or **Can bus**.

Ambiguity rule. If it is unclear whether a term is a UI element or a plain-language description, leave it unstyled until it can be checked against the interface.

6. Document Structure

This section outlines the overall and specific patterns for documents.

6.1. Overall Structure of Chapters

1. Introduction: What you bought, what it does.
2. Installation Prep
 - a. What should be on-hand
 - b. BOMs for subsystems
 - c. List of optional parts to check
3. Hardware Install
 - a. Step-by-step, as complete as possible given system complexity
 - b. Complete all HW install before moving on to SW
4. Setup: initial configuration of all required settings in software
5. Functional tests: confirmation the system is working
6. Interface
 - a. Walk-through of all screens in the interface
 - b. Explanation of settings not in initial setup
7. Operation
 - a. Step-by-step to get running
 - b. What to monitor during operation
 - c. Shutdown procedure (if needed)
8. Tuning
 - a. Suggested settings for various configurations
 - b. Procedures for feedback loops (adjust, check, adjust, etc)
9. Troubleshooting: Symptom, possible causes, solutions
10. Technical Resources
 - a. Parts lists
 - b. Harness Diagrams
 - c. Pinouts
 - d. Accessories
 - e. Related Documents
11. Index

6.2. Other Patterns

- **Topic opening pattern:** When starting a new section (particularly chapters) include a short paragraph that explains what the feature/system is, why it would be used, what follows.
Sentinel Row Monitoring continuously monitors feedback from Flowmeter Modules to verify application performance at each row. The following procedure describes normal operation of the system.
- **Procedure pattern:** Prerequisites → Procedure → Expected Results structure.
 - Procedures with dependencies should include a Prerequisites section immediately before instructions.
 - Procedures that produce a system change should end with expected results.
- **Troubleshooting format:** Symptoms, Causes, Corrective Actions

7. Indexing

An index is an important tool for users of paper documents (many of SurePoint's customers/dealers during install). A good index helps the reader find information that a search would turn up online.

General Rules

Use noun phrases: Lead with nouns (e.g., "error codes," not "handling error codes").

Organize with subentries.

Put terms in standard order and inverted: Screen, hardware and Hardware, screen.

Use "See": to point readers from a term you did not use to the term you did use ("RAM, see memory").

Match document terms: Use the exact words and feature names found in the text.

In Paligo, to insert an index entry:

1. Place the cursor in the correct location in the text.
2. Select alt + enter.
3. Type "indexterm"
4. Enter the index term between the element boundaries >>term<< .
5. For subentries, move the cursor between the right element boundary indicators <|<, press alt + enter, and select **Secondary**.

This page is intentionally left blank.

8. Terms

Term	Definition
Sentinel	The overall Sentinel system, however it is configured.
Sentinel ECU	The physical Sentinel control component. ECU is always ALLCAPs
Flowmeter Module	Sentinel physical component that measures flow on a per-row basis.
Rate Control	System for controlling the rate of application, usually measured in quantity per acre. Title Case.
Row Monitoring	System for monitoring the flow on a per-row basis. Title Case.
Flow monitoring / flow metering	Monitoring the flow of liquid. Use this term only for the overall monitoring of flow. Try to avoid this exact phrase when describing the work of the flowmeter modules.
Row Control	System for controlling the rate of application on a per-row basis. Title Case.
Section control	System for controlling application by section. Sections are an arbitrary unit of sub-systems.
Row Control valve	Sentinel physical component that controls flow on a per-row basis
Valve Interface Module	The device that connects four Row Control valves to the Sentinel wiring harness. Title Case.
CAN Zip valves	Addressable on/off per-row valves controlled by Sentinel and connected to the CAN bus. CAN is an acronym (ALLCAPs) CAN Zip is the proper name.
Zip valves	Non-addressable on/off per-row valves controlled by Sentinel and connected to the wiring harness.

This page is intentionally left blank.